

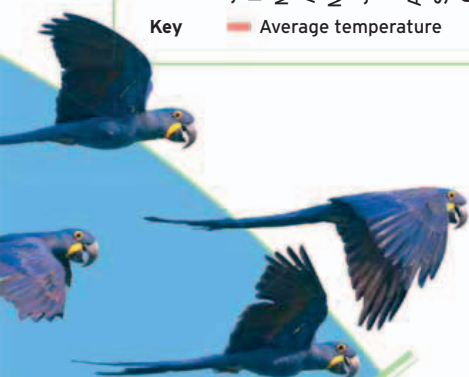
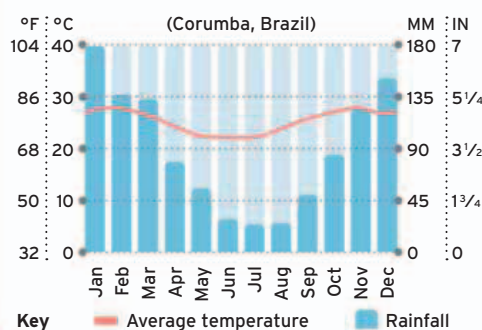
LOCATION

The Pantanal is located to the south of the Amazon river basin in central South America. Around 80% of it is in Brazil.



CLIMATE

The Pantanal has a tropical, semihumid climate. The extent and depth of the floodwater varies markedly according to rainfall.



bird, and 325 species of fish

RUNAWAY PLANT
The fast-growing water hyacinth forms free-floating mats in the Paraguay River and lagoons of the Pantanal. It is an invasive species in many countries, but there may be potential to harness its large biomass for generating bio-energy.

WATER HYACINTH



White-lipped peccary

Tayassu pecari

large, sharp, interlocking canine teeth



One of the most social mammals, white-lipped peccaries move, feed, and rest together in herds ranging from five to hundreds of individuals. With jaws capable of cracking palm nuts, a group of peccaries can fend off natural predators such as jaguars. Human hunters, however, prey on herds, killing large numbers at a time, which has had a devastating impact on the species.



- ↔ 30–39 in (76–100 cm)
- ⚖ 55–88 lb (25–40 kg)
- ⊗ Vulnerable
- 🍌 Fruit, nuts, small vertebrates
- 🏠 🌳 🌿 🍌 🍌 🍌 🍌 🍌 🍌



Central to South America

GROUP IDENTITY

Peccaries spread rump scent-gland secretions among members to create a musky herd odor.

Capybara

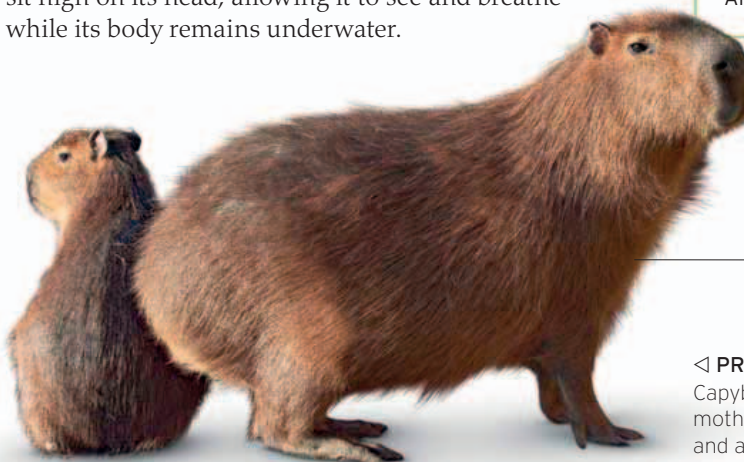
Hydrochoerus hydrochaeris

Related to guinea pigs, the capybara is the world's largest living rodent, closer in size to a large domestic dog. It is heavy bodied, with short but sturdy limbs, and almost no tail. This placid, sociable mammal spends much of its time in rivers and lakes, partly to avoid predators such as wild dogs, pumas, and jaguars. Partially webbed, hooflike toes make it an excellent swimmer, and its eyes, nose, and ears sit high on its head, allowing it to see and breathe while its body remains underwater.

- ↔ 4 ft (1.2 m)
- ⚖ 77–145 lb (35–66 kg)
- ⊗ Common
- 🍌 Aquatic plants, bark, grasses
- 🏠 🌳 🌿 🍌 🍌 🍌 🍌 🍌 🍌



N. and E. South America



coarse but sparse hair

PRECOCIOUS YOUNG

Capybara pups can follow their mothers into water shortly after birth and are able to graze within a week.